MONTHLY UPDATE

Burundi: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-3 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation

Strategies, plans and policies

DRAFT LAW ON ACCESS TO PUBLIC INFORMATION

- **Burundi adopts Right-to-Information Law, with broad exceptions** — Burundi Times, 30 September 2026

  Burundi's Senate unanimously adopted a bill on 29 September 2026 creating a legal right of access to public information. It sets up a National Commission on Access to Public Information to hear appeals and requires covered bodies to publish some information proactively, with exceptions for national security, private life and ongoing judicial investigations. The bill sets no ceiling on access fees.

Legislation and regulation

ACCESS TO INFORMATION BILL

- **Burundi adopts Right-to-Information Law, with broad exceptions** — Burundi Times, 30 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

ORDONNANCE MINISTERIELLE N 540/906/2026 ON SIM REGISTRATION

- **Burundi SIM registration process faces challenges, scams persist** — Connecting Africa, 2 October 2026

  Burundi's mandatory SIM and eSIM registration, begun in mid-June, was about 70 per cent complete on the regulator's count. Users report long queues, few service points and slow systems, and scams continue; operators must keep customer data for at least five years.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Connectivity

INTERNATIONAL CAPACITY THROUGH NEIGHBOURING LANDINGS

- **TTCL and BBS Increase Tanzania-Burundi Connectivity Capacity from 4Gbps to 10Gbps** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026 TANZANIA

> Tanzania's state operator agreed with Burundi Backbone System to raise cross-border capacity from 4Gbps to 10Gbps through the National ICT Broadband Backbone, framed as a response to demand for cross-border digital services and enterprise connectivity.

DPI

Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

Digital Payments and Fintech

EAC REGIONAL CROSS-BORDER PAYMENT SYSTEM MASTER PLAN

- **Regional lawmakers flag unfinished Burundi Payment Systems Work as grant closes** — Burundi Times, 10 October 2026

  The East African Legislative Assembly's accounts committee reported that Burundi left parts of the regional payment-systems integration project unfinished when its grant closed in June. It recommends an audit and a costed completion plan; the central bank says it still intends to join the East African Payment System by December.

Registries

2027 ELECTORAL REGISTER PREPARATION

- **2027 presidential election : more than one million new voters, CENI accelerates preparations - SOS Médias Burundi** — SOS Medias Burundi, 3 September 2026

  Burundi's electoral commission CENI expects more than one million new voters on the register for the 2027 presidential election, its president Prosper Ntahorwamiye said on 28 August 2026. Partial registration is planned for October 2026 in more than 4,000 centres, aimed at those under 18 in 2025 and returnees. Exact dates have not been set.

CARTE D'ASSISTANCE MEDICALE (CAM)

- **La CAM, une avancée vers une protection sociale plus inclusive ?** — Iwacu, 14 March 2025

  A joint ministerial ordinance of 7 February 2025 requires every Burundian household outside a health mutual, and every adult aged 18 or over, to buy a Carte d'Assurance Maladie (CAM). Burundi's revenue office set the card's price at 3,000 Burundian francs. The CAM dates from 1984 and became voluntary in 2012; the public-service mutual covers about 10% of the population.

Sectoral management information systems

E-JUSTICE PENAL-CHAIN PLATFORM

- **Burundi : la numérisation de la justice face au défi de la connectivité** — wearetech.africa, 5 October 2026

  Burundi is preparing an E-Justice platform to link the penal chain from the judicial police to the prisons, with online complaints and case tracking for citizens. An earlier programme digitised more than 15,000 case files, and the article sets the plan against an internet use rate of about 11%.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

GASAPE CHAT AS THE PRESIDENCY'S CITIZEN GRIEVANCE CHANNEL

- **Burundi opts for a local app for presidency-citizen interactions** — Connecting Africa, 8 October 2026

  Burundi's presidency adopted Gasape Chat, a locally built messaging application, as a channel for citizens' grievances. The terms were not disclosed, and analysts noted that nothing says who controls the servers or protects users' data.

Technology

AI

AI

NATIONAL AI STRATEGY 2026-2030

- **Intelligence artificielle : à Séoul, le Burundi présente ses ambitions** — wearetech.africa, 10 September 2026

  Burundi presented the ambitions of its national artificial intelligence strategy at the Korea-Africa economic cooperation ministerial in Seoul, seeking the financing and partnerships to turn it into concrete projects. The strategy, validated in April, provides for strengthening connectivity, data infrastructure and local skills; the country's digital capacity remains limited.

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